

more graphics power when set up at a desk. Overall, the Ally is a capable handheld Windows PC, offering a unique blend of gaming and PC functionality. Despite a few navigational quirks, it's a strong contender in the handheld gaming market, especially for those who prefer the familiarity and versatility of Windows.

Gaming and Performance

When it comes to ROG Ally's performance, there are two main areas to focus on - its real-world gaming performance and its everyday capabilities. Because don't forget that the ASUS ROG Ally does have an HDMI 1.4 port and can output a 1080p display at 60Hz. Which should be enough if you want to do basic computing stuff. But if you wish to do that then there is a tiny problem. You see the folks at ASUS were so happy that they've finally made a portable handheld gaming device that they forgot to put an additional USB port except the charging port. In all seriousness though, it is an issue.

Because there is only one USB Type-C port you will need a USB hub to connect it to an external monitor and attach a keyboard and mouse. But the moment you connect the charging port through the USB hub you won't get access to the ultra-powerful 30W Turbo mode. And as you can see from my benchmarks there is some difference between these modes in terms of CPU as well as gaming performance. Take note however that the entire 30W isn't being used by the CPU. As you're aware the AMD Ryzen Z1 Extreme is an APU (Accelerated Processing Unit). Meaning the CPU and the GPU are placed on the same die. The CPU Package power during the Cinebench R23 test remains around 14-15W throughout the test.

But the good news is that it isn't much. For instance, you can see that between 25-30W there is hardly any difference in gaming performance. So you can rest assured because the



ASUS ROG Ally will give you enough power to be on the move. Or even if you decide to sit down and turn it into a desktop PC.

Now, after talking about all the peculiarities, just how good is the ASUS ROG Ally in terms of raw gaming performance? Well! Here are different charts taken at ROG Ally's different power levels. If you're considering the use of headphones, you'll be pleased to know that this device features both an audio jack and Bluetooth 5.2 compatibility. Unfortunately, the downside is the battery's limited lifespan - it only lasts between 50 to 60 minutes. Excitingly, this model boasts two turbo modes: a 25W version and a more powerful 30W one. The latter, however, can only be unlocked when you're plugged into the Ally's designated charger. It's not compatible

with other chargers, so you'll need to take good care of the original one.

Yet, the differences between the two modes are surprisingly minimal. You can witness this firsthand by observing the slight FPS differential on screen, a design choice made to guarantee a consistently fluid gaming experience. Let's talk about performance. I compared the ROG Ally against a gaming laptop set at 1080p high settings and, as anticipated, there's a discernible performance gap. The performance-per-watt (PPW) of the AMD Z1 Extreme chip is a standout feature, however. Drawing just a maximum of 30W, this chip consistently delivers smooth frame rates across numerous games, a feat that's quite remarkable. The biggest performance jump in performance you'll see is when you turn to jump from silent mode at 10W to Performance mode at 15W. Meanwhile, the performance difference between 25W to 30W is almost negligible be it in terms of in-game FPS or outright CPU performance.

Conclusion

To sum up, the ROG Ally is indeed a promising device despite having a few minor drawbacks. However, these issues don't hamper the overall user experience. The key question, though, is identifying the ideal market in India for this product. In the United States, where disposable income is generally higher, splurging a few hundred dollars on a device like this is not uncommon. However, in India, consumers often prioritise high Value for Money (VFM) when making purchases. Now, there's no denying that the ROG Ally delivers in that department. But, when you compare it with other alternatives like a PS5 or a gaming laptop at a similar price point, these options tend to offer more VFM. That said, if you're open to making a few compromises, the ROG Ally is indeed an attractive machine that's sure to provide a satisfying experience. *